

Arab world condemns Netanyahu's remarks

CAIRO

The Arab League has strongly condemned the statements made by Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu regarding the annexation of parts of the territories of sovereign Arab states, in preparation for the establishment of what he called "Greater Israel."

The League considered these statements to be a violation of the sovereignty of Arab states and an attempt to undermine security and stability in the region.

In a statement released late Tuesday, the League said these remarks represent a serious threat to collective Arab national security and a flagrant challenge to international law and the principles of international legitimacy. The statements also reflect expansionist and aggressive intentions that cannot be accepted or tolerated, and they reveal an extremist mindset steeped in colonial delusions.

Egypt slams statements

Within the same context, Egypt has condemned the statements raised in some Israeli media regarding the so-called "Greater Israel," while affirming its commitment to establishing peace in the Middle East. In a statement issued by the Egyptian Ministry of Foreign Affairs on Wednesday evening, Egypt demanded official clarifications regarding these statements due to the indications they carry that could trigger instability.

— WAM

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Dubai economy expands 4% in Q1 driven by health sector

HUMAN HEALTH AND SOCIAL WORK SECTOR SURGES BY AN IMPRESSIVE 26%

DUBAI

BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai's economy has demonstrated robust health in the first quarter of 2025, recording a Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of Dh119.7 billion, a 4 per cent increase compared to the same period last year.

The most striking element of this growth came from the Human Health and Social Work sector, which surged by an impressive 26 per cent.

The performance of the health sector, with a total value of Dh1.9 billion, contributed 0.3 percentage points to Dubai's overall economic expansion.

This highlights the city's strategic focus on strengthening its health care infrastructure and its growing reputation as a hub for medical services.

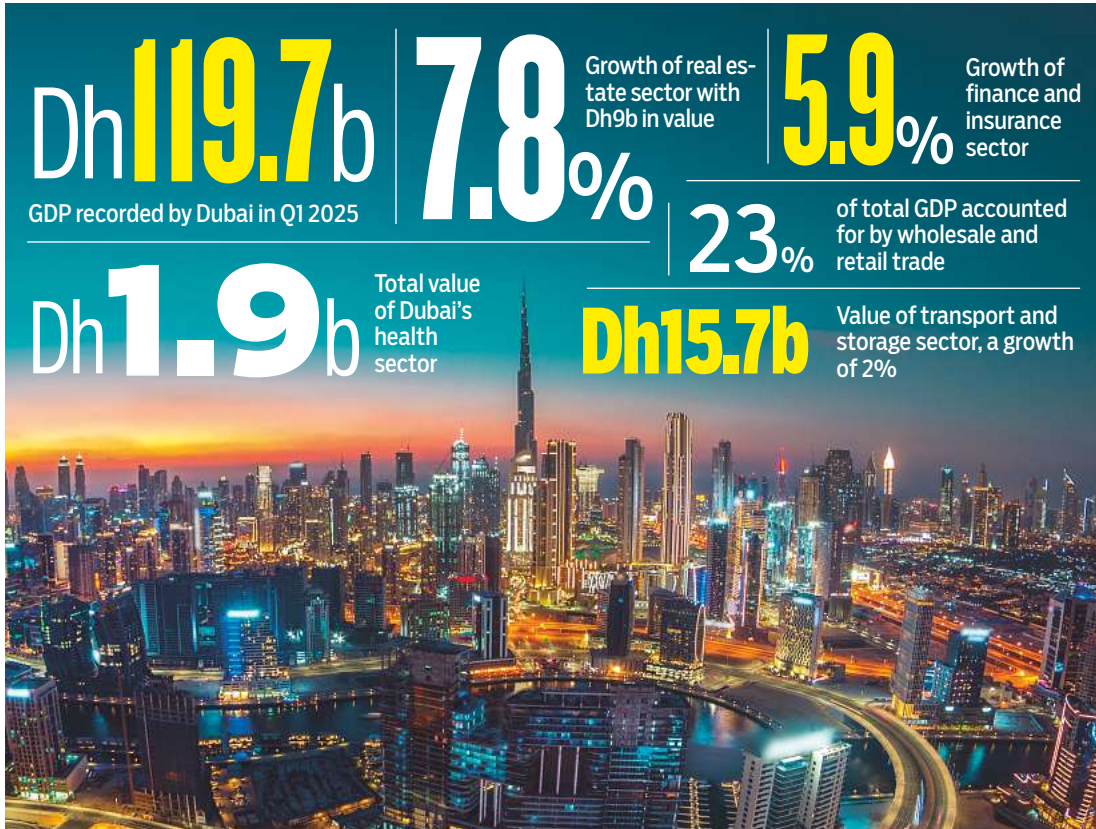
Strong momentum

The positive economic trajectory is a continuation of strong momentum from 2024, when Dubai's economy expanded by a total of 3.2 per cent at constant prices. The city's economic foundation remains broad and diversified, with multiple sectors contributing to the latest figures.

Other key sectors also showed significant growth in Q1 2025:

■ **Real estate:** A cornerstone of the economy, the real estate sector grew by 7.8 per cent with a value of Dh9 billion. It contributed 7.5 per cent to the emirate's GDP

■ **Finance and insurance:**



This sector expanded by 5.9 per cent, reaching a value of Dh16 billion and contributing 13.4 per cent to Dubai's economy.

■ **Wholesale and retail trade:** As the largest contributor to the economy, this sector was valued at Dh27.5 billion, a 4.5 per cent increase. It accounted for 23 per cent of the total GDP.

■ **Transport and storage:** This sector, vital for Dubai's role as a global hub, saw a 2 per cent growth to reach Dh15.7 billion. Air transport was the biggest driver within this sector.

■ **Accommodation and food**

services: This sector, a key component of Dubai's tourism industry, grew by 3.4 per cent to Dh4.9 billion.

Global appeal

According to Hadi Badri, CEO of Dubai Economic Development Corporation, the sustained and diversified growth underscores the city's global appeal for businesses, investors, and entrepreneurs. The performance is seen as a key step toward achieving the goals of the Dubai Economic Agenda D33.

The robust growth across

these diverse sectors, particularly the standout performance in health and social work, points to a dynamic and resilient economy well-positioned to meet its ambitious future goals.

Younus Al Nasser, Chief Executive of the Dubai Data and Statistics Establishment, Digital Dubai, emphasised the importance of reliable data in this new era of artificial intelligence.

He stated that the Q1 results provide essential insights for policymakers and businesses, supporting the government's forward-looking vision.

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Trump warns of make-or-break chance with Putin as pressure mounts

Russian President welcomes US efforts to end Ukraine conflict

ANCHORAGE

Pressure mounted ahead of a landmark summit in Alaska between the United States and Russia, as Donald Trump warned that Vladimir Putin had only one chance but Moscow pressed ahead with major battlefield gains in Ukraine.

Putin and Trump will meet today at an airbase in the far-northern US state, with the Russian President yesterday welcoming US efforts to end the Ukraine conflict.

"The US administration ... in my view is making quite ener-



If I feel that it's not appropriate to have it because I didn't get the answers that we have to have, then we are not going to have a second meeting."

Donald Trump
US President

getic and sincere efforts to end the fighting," Putin told a meeting of top officials.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, who has refused to surrender territory to Russia, spoke by telephone Wednesday with Trump, as did European leaders who voiced confidence

afterward that the US leader would seek a ceasefire rather than concessions by Kyiv.

Trump himself sent mixed messages, saying that he could quickly organise a three-way summit afterward with both Zelensky and Putin but also warning of his impatience with Putin. "There may be no second meeting because, if I feel that it's not appropriate to have it because I didn't get the answers that we have to have, then we are not going to have a second meeting," Trump told reporters.

Russia, Trump said, would face "severe consequences" if it does not halt its offensive. But Trump said: "If the first one goes okay, we'll have a quick second one," involving both Putin and Zelensky.

— AFP

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Happy 79th Independence Day



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